



Prabin Pebam

DESIGN LEADER · PRODUCT STRATEGY · AI TRANSFORMATION

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PROFILE

Design leader, strategist, and maker with 18 years of experience spanning physical product design, UX, product strategy, design organizations, and emerging technology. I work across strategy and execution—going deep into complex problems, building expertise, and connecting that expertise to broader product and organizational outcomes.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Design Manager *at* Microsoft

July 2019 – Present

PRODUCT & STRATEGY

- Lead design across Windows and Microsoft consumer experiences, managing teams of **5–9 designers** across product, design, and organizational initiatives.
- Built and transitioned the India-based design capability for **Microsoft Family Safety** from an augmentation model to complete design ownership across web, iOS, and Android.
- Defined the strategy for **Family Safety** and its evolution into the broader **Microsoft Family** product direction, while leading the design team responsible for execution.
- Defined product strategy for **Windows cross-device experiences**, including sharing across Windows, Android, iOS, and third-party platforms.
- Shaped the strategy for Windows continuity experiences including **Windows Resume** and **Live Notifications**, connecting experiences across devices and contexts.
- Defined the strategy for **People in Windows** and led the team through execution.
- Led the effort to improve **Craft in Windows**, defining a new approach and driving leadership alignment.
- Partnered with the M365 Copilot team to define **deep integration of Copilot on Windows**.
- Defined **agentic personalization of Windows**, where the entire Windows theme is customized using agentic workflows.

AI TRANSFORMATION

Figma is no longer how Designers hand off specifications.

- Led the shift toward **coded prototyping**, where working prototypes become the primary Design-to-Engineering handoff artifact and Designers iterate directly in code rather than translating designs into implementation specifications.
- Built deep hands-on expertise across generative AI, agentic harnesses, graphs and loops, and skills, then translated that expertise into an **AI transformation program for Design**.
- Established the foundations for Designers to **work directly in production codebases using agentic coding**, including workflows and guardrails that enable Designers to safely contribute to production software.
- Drove AI adoption across the immediate team and broader Microsoft Design organization through learning programs, workshops, hands-on demonstrations, recorded tutorials, whitepapers, and leadership engagement.
- Scaled adoption by developing **AI champions and evangelists** within teams, creating a cascading model through which each champion could enable their immediate organization; extended the effort beyond India to the Windows Design team in Seattle.

- Shifted the conversation around AI from **adoption and usage toward throughput, quality, and organizational impact**, changing how Design evaluates the value of AI-enabled ways of working.
- Led learning initiatives across Windows Design and Microsoft Design in India, helping Designers develop new capabilities and adapt their role as technology and product development evolve.

Head of Design *at Belong*

July 2015 – 2019

- Built the **Belong Design organization from scratch**, establishing hiring, interviewing, evaluation, onboarding, and individual success frameworks.
- Established the Belong Design Community and a **Task Relevant Maturity framework** to create a structured approach to designer development and career growth.
- Reported directly to the CEO and represented Design and user perspectives in **business-level decisions** as a member of the Core Leadership Team.
- Extended Design's influence beyond Product and Engineering into **pricing, sales, organizational structure, governance, and broader business decisions**.
- Built the **Belong Design System from scratch**, establishing guidelines, pattern libraries, adoption practices, and a model for continuous improvement across the product family.
- Established the design and product-development operating system spanning collaboration, version control, developer handoff, product analytics, onboarding, contextual help, and knowledge-base experiences.

Core Founding Team Member *at DesignUp*

2016 – Present

- Core founding contributor to **DesignUp**, a community and conference for product creators, designers, makers, and technology leaders across India and Southeast Asia.
- Built and operated the creative and technical production for DesignUp events, spanning photography, video, motion, websites, registration, event technology, and vendor coordination across multiple cities and countries.

UX Designer *at Projectplace*

March 2013 – June 2015

- Designed core collaboration and communication experiences for the Projectplace project-management platform, including conversation, commenting, notifications, settings, access control, and email communications.
- Established product-wide email guidelines and templates for communicating with users.

Designer *at TVS Motor*

August 2008 – March 2013

- Designed vehicle graphics, speedometers, and dashboards for production and concept motorcycles, including electric-hybrid vehicles.
- Trained in professional **Class-A surfacing** and independently built a presentation-management system for large-scale motorcycle design reviews.

EDUCATION

Indian Institute of Science **IISc**

Master of Design, Product Design · 2006 – 2008

North Eastern Regional Institute of Science & Technology **NERIST**

B.Tech., Mechanical Engineering · 2002 – 2006

ADDITIONAL

DesignUp

Core founding team member and community contributor.